

Release and Deployment Policy

Purpose

This policy sets out when Harbourline Freight Systems engineering may deploy to production, how a release is rolled out safely, and who must approve a production deployment.

Deploy windows

Production deployments are permitted Monday to Thursday. No deploys are made on Fridays, so that any issue arising from a release has a full business day of team availability behind it rather than running into the weekend. Deployments outside the standard window require sign-off from the release manager and the on-call primary.

Day	Deploys permitted
Monday–Thursday	Yes
Friday	No

Canary rollout

Every production release is first rolled out to a canary slice of 10% of traffic, held for 30 minutes before proceeding to full rollout. The canary period allows error rates and latency to be observed on a limited blast radius before the release reaches all customers.

Automatic rollback

If the error rate observed during the canary period, or after full rollout, rises above 2%, the release is automatically rolled back to the previous version without waiting for manual intervention. An automatic rollback pages the on-call primary, who follows the Incident Response Policy to assess customer impact and classify the event.

Approval

Every production deployment requires approval from the release manager before it proceeds, in addition to the standard code review process. The release manager checks that the canary and rollback configuration for the release are correctly set before granting approval.